
UNIT 18 EVENT MANAGEMENT

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18.0 INTRODUCTION

Be it a small family function or a grand event, I am sure most of us have attended at least one event in our lifetime. Have you ever wondered how a Filmfare awards ceremony or Miss India beauty pageant comes to life? Were you one of the spectators of Indian Idol or Dance India Dance grand finale? Did you enjoy the laser show, the fireworks, and loved the beautiful décor of any of the recent events you've attended? Behind every such show there is a team work; professional event manager works tirelessly behind the stage so that you can enjoy your show without a glitch. What appears to be so simple from afar actually needs strategic planning and management? The objective of this unit is to make you aware of the process of event management.

18.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After the successful understanding of this unit, you will be able to:

- describe the process of event management and the role of event managers;
- discuss principles and practices of event management;
- describe the budgeting process, and elements of event management;
- plan and evaluate events; and
- analyse event environment and its role in marketing.

18.2 WHAT IS EVENT MANAGEMENT?

18.2.1 What are Events?

Human beings are social animals and therefore they keep interacting with each other through various means of communication and on different platforms. Celebrations and entertainment are an integral part of social existence. We need reasons to come together hence need for events arises both in public and private life. Events are not only planned for entertainment but also for official purposes. For example, NGOs do it for fund raising, governments for announcing their policies or to reach the citizens, educational institutions for meeting and interacting with likeminded people, and corporate houses use it as an important marketing tool to reach their consumers.

The word 'event' has its origin from the Latin term '*eventus*' which mean occurrence or outcome. The Oxford dictionary defines events as, "a thing that happens or takes place, especially one of importance".

18.2.2 Role of Event Manager

As the title suggests, the event manager has to manage the events. But what does that mean exactly? Let us have an overview of the same. Event managers will have to understand the nature of the event and its target audiences first. Then he/she will have to plan strategically to meet the management goals. The plan will aim at optimum utilisation allocated resources and their minimum wastage. He/she will have to develop, produce and deliver the project right from the proposal level.

One also has to adhere to deadlines, understand the budget constraints, manage suppliers, and ensure customer satisfaction. The event manager must be an excellent communicator, a team builder, have leadership qualities, creative, ability to initiate things, strong problem solving skills, and have multitasking abilities.

18.2.3 Types of events

Charity and Fundraising events	• Charitable auctions • Charitable shows
Cultural events	• Festive celebrations • E.g. Dandiya, Ganesh utsav, Diwali nights.
Private events	• Weddings • Anniversaries • Birthday parties
Sports events	• E.g. IPL, Olympics, Commonwealth games.
Government, civic and political events	• Speeches • Party meetings • Rallies
Religious events	• Speeches • Religious conventions
Entertainment and leisure events	• Fashion shows • Musical events: • Award functions
Academic events	• Conferences, symposia, seminars, workshops, round tables, plenary, congress
Corporate/business events	The above list is not exhaustive but most important event categories are included in the table.

18.2.4 Technology and Event Management

With the advent and advancement of technology, event management industry is also booming and flourishing. Technology is becoming an integral part of events; be it social media or handheld devices and mobile phones. Right from organizing and planning an event for reaching potential audience to collecting feedback from them; technology has a role to play at each stage. Following are some examples:

- Social media:** Event managers can make their official Facebook pages, write blogs, tweet about their event announcements and reach the target audience in real time.
- Live meetings:** Webinars and live meetings have broken the shackle of space and people from all corners of the world who have internet access can attend these virtual events.

- c) Smart phones: These are designed to take care of almost all our communication problems. They enable communication, virtual presence and participation in form of text, audio and video from anywhere at any time.
- d) Websites/online registration apps: They can be used as a one stop shop point. Information can be updated, announcements can be made in real time, invitations/cancellations can be managed and also payments can be made online.

This advancement in technology has resulted in increased event life; one can immediately post the event schedule and it will be accessed by people in real time. Besides, any last minute changes can be updated or errors can be rectified immediately. With social media and smart phones more personalised communication is becoming possible thereby resulting in better communication between the organizers and the attendees.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. What are the qualities of a good event manager?

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2. List different types of event management.

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18.3 EVENT MANAGEMENT STRATEGIES

18.3.1 What is Strategic Planning?

For successful accomplishment of any project, one has to have an effective plan. Plans define goals and also identify ways of achieving goals. Please note that strategic planning is not a onetime activity but is a process and therefore needs to be continually observed.

18.3.2 Conceptualizing and Planning the Event

Conceptualizing is an art as well a science; one has to use asystematic schema creatively to devise a sound plan. One should evaluate the opportunities and try to encash them. Have a clear understanding of the objectives before conceptualizing the event. Understand your 5 W's and 1 H i.e. why is the event organized, for whom is it organized, what will be your plan of action, whenis it scheduled, where will it be organized and how will you go about it?

18.3.3 Elements of the Planning Process

Planning should be done well in advance to avoid crisis. Elements of event planning are:

- Check the feasibility of the event
- Situation analysis and brainstorming
- Identify sponsorship opportunities
- Find out venue and other logistics availability
- Form your team and assign roles
- Set deadlines keeping event dates in mind
- Evaluate budget provisions
- Marketing of the event
- Media co-ordination
- Execution of the event
- Post-event evaluation and feedback

18.3.3.1 Staging Events

The Oxford dictionary defines staging as, “the method of presenting a play or other dramatic performance or organizing of a public event or protest.” Simply it means bringing all the elements of a planned event together in order to present them in front of its audience. Let us have a look at what are the different elements that need to be brought together in order to stage an event?

The first and foremost amongst the elements is choice and organization of a venue. Before finalising any venue one has to first understand the number of expected audiences, the budget, nature of event, who are the invited speakers and dignitaries, security risks, timing of the event, weather conditions, availability and arrangement of sound and light system, and whether there is any need for special effects, for example, laser work and firework.

Once the venue is final, the event manager has to keep the event theme in mind and decorate and arrange things accordingly. Event theme will depend upon the nature of the event. Circus, Hollywood, Bollywood, Nostalgia, Wild and Retro are some examples of event themes. Even the sound and lights should be arranged in accordance to the event theme. Pay attention to the seating arrangements, entry and exit of the audiences. Proper navigation of people should be planned in order to avoid chaos. Make the venue accessible if physically handicapped people will be amongst your audiences. Basic facilities such as toilet, drinking water, first-aid kit and parking facility should be arranged.

Keep plan B ready in case of crisis and emergency and also have provision for emergency exit. Make one point communication contact to avoid any confusion.

The message or the content that needs to be passed on to the audiences is the next big thing and therefore logical arrangement of performances and speeches must be finalised and executed accordingly. Performances should be planned

keeping audience taste, sponsor's requirements and event theme in mind. If you are planning to record the event, then make necessary arrangements.

Catering is another important element of staging. While planning catering, identify whether it is formal or informal dinner, then find out number of people and their food preferences, requirement of service staff and others. Care should be taken for obvious reasons if you are planning to serve alcohol. And lastly, check and double check everything before going on board.

18.3.3.2 Logistics Management

When managing logistics for events, event managers must understand that it will differ from event to event basis and therefore one cannot have a uniform logistics management (LM) strategy for all. The elements of LM are:

- **People management:** It may comprise of audience of the event or the sponsors or the team behind managing the event. If the event entry is ticket/fee based then needed arrangements should be made. You may use internet for selling of tickets and registering for the event along with the counters at the venue.
- **Transportation:** Are you planning to provide a pick and drop facility to the audience? If yes, then plan properly. What would be the mode of transportation public or private vehicles? Their arrival and departure schedules should be maintained. What are the provisions to control the traffic flow?
- **Product management:** Make note of what possible products may be required for the event at different stages. Right from a safety pin to huge generators to first-aid box to CDs/DVDs, it can be anything and therefore logistic managers must prepare the product requirement list meticulously.
- **Accommodation:** It can be arranged if needed for participants or performers.
- **Infrastructure and communication:** Stall set ups, kiosks and booths. if required need to be made. Ensure that your infrastructure is disabled person friendly. There should be proper communication happening between the organizers, with the audiences and also with the performers. One can arrange for walkie-talkie, sign boards, microphones for announcements, CCTV, or similar equipment for communicating with each other.
- **Solid waste management:** It will be unethical and unprofessional if you leave the place messy and chaotic after the event is over. It is your responsibility to make sure that the place is organized just like it was before the event took place.

18.3.3.3 Crowd and Risk Management

The business dictionary defines risk management (RM) as “the identification, analysis, assessment, control, and avoidance, minimization, or elimination of unacceptable risks.” An organization may use risk assumption, risk avoidance, risk retention, risk transfer, or any other strategy (or combination of strategies) in proper management of future events.

Events are audience oriented and therefore there is no doubt that there will be a pool of people to attend these. In such situation overall safety and security becomes the prime concern. Event managers must evaluate all the possible situations where crowd can go out of control. Clear guidelines should be given on code of conduct. Security check posts should be arranged at various points. Make rules and ensure that they are passed on to its publics. Hire trained crowd management personnel. If needed, local police can be called for patrolling and surveillance.

There may be gas leakage resulting in choking, have plans ready in case of natural disasters; keep all emergency contact numbers handy. Arrange for necessary equipment in case of fire or electricity accidents. Get approval from fire and police departments. Overcrowding should not be allowed. Barricades or rope lines can be placed for proper navigation of people. In short, crowd and risk management is all about identifying, eliminating and controlling risks and ensuring smooth functioning of the event.

18.3.4 Human Resource Management and Events

Planning human resources for an event is a task in itself. Before selecting your personnel, you need to understand the event strategies and objectives. Human resource management (HRM) includes assessing the actual human force needed for the event, identifying skilled people, assigning tasks to them, job analysis and job description, motivating them to increase productivity, training, making them aware of the work culture, their duties and responsibilities, planning towards reducing absenteeism, and promoting positive work environment.

Recruitment and selection: Many a time the human resource is hired on a temporary basis i.e. till the execution of the event. In such a situation it is very important to keep your staff motivated and committed. Event managers will have to train the staff/ volunteers as per the event requirements. Pulling the right talent for your event is extremely challenging. One of the prime factors in deciding HR is the total budget allocated for HRM. With internet and social networking sites, it has become much easier and cost effective to reach to prospective employees. You may ask them to fill an application form to understand their qualification, work experience and orientation towards the job. Once initial scrutiny of forms is done, then the shortlisted candidates may be called for an interview. If everything goes off well, then they may be given an offer letter mentioning details of the key responsibility areas (KRA). Remember that all the formalities should be on paper duly signed by the authorities and candidates consent should be taken before proceeding further. An appointment letter may be then issued to the candidates giving details of job title, their code of conduct, salary and allowances details, job timings and responsibilities, termination procedure and leave details. If you are planning to hire volunteers instead of employees then a simple letter in a contract form may be given.

HRM will not work if your staffs are not motivated enough to work towards the task. You may think of giving incentives in order to increase productivity. These incentives may be financial (for example, cash, and increase in basic salary or allowances) or non-financial (gifts, picnics, or simply words of appreciation). Ensure that you acknowledge their efforts and arrange a 'Thank You' party for all the volunteers and staff members after the successful completion of the event.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. What does logistics management comprise of?

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2. State whether following statements are True or False:

- a. Organising event is a team work.
- b. Planning should not be done in advance.
- c. Event theme depends upon the nature of the event.
- d. Safety and security of audiences is not important.
- e. Human resources are always hired on a voluntary basis.

18.4 EVENT MANAGEMENT BUDGETING

This section will help you understand the financial implications of organizing an event. Budget is the backbone of any event and therefore care should be taken while utilizing it. There are two aspects in budgeting i.e. income and expenditure. Let us see how one can use resources optimally to minimise expenses and maximise income.

18.4.1 Constructing the Budget

Scale of the event dictates the budget requirement. Be it any type of event, careful utilization is very necessary. Budgeting primarily involves preparation and presentation of financial accounting. Keep the overall objectives of the event in backdrop while planning the budget.

Setting budget enforces a discipline and therefore event managers are compelled to plan and execute accordingly. If it is a sponsored event, then there may be demands from the sponsors to allocate budget in a specific manner. The first step in planning a budget is to identify the areas of expenditure and income. By doing this, one will get a fair idea of the total cost. Let us have a look at it in the table given below:

Sr No.	Income	Sr No.	Expenditure
1	Sponsorships: from associations, companies, federations, trusts	1	Venue cost
2	Sales: tickets, any other item such as food and beverages	2	Salaries/wages: volunteers, technicians, employees, artists, labours, co-ordinators, supervisors

3	Registration fees	3	Insurance
4	Donations	4	Administration: Office rent, stationery, telephone
5	Grants	5	Food, travel and accommodation
6	Rents (from stalls and others)	6	Equipment purchase/hire: Sound and light system, stage, tents, tables, chairs, kiosks, generators, uniforms
7	Individual contributions	7	Contingencies and miscellaneous
8	Fundraising	8	Permissions: Parking, fire, police, liquor
		9	Publicity: Printing and artwork, print, radio and TV advertisements, media kit

18.4.2 How to Reduce Costs?

The success of planning a budget depends upon how effectively you are able to reduce costs without compromising on the quality of the output. Event managers must have very good negotiation skills. Apart from this, he/she can strategise the budget by looking at following aspects of the budget and reduce costs:

- Try to include more volunteers than the paid staff. Also ensure that their skills are fully utilised.
- Understand exact requirements of equipment to avoid over hiring of them.
- Publicity is one area where you spend the most. One can reduce costs on unnecessary spending by targeting precise audiences and saving on wastage. If you know exactly where your target audiences would be then you should be using that media to reach to them.
- Try to have program partners instead of paying them i.e. sign a contra deal with them. For example, you may associate with a radio channel for radio advertisements and a beverage company for free supply of beverages. Against which they get free publicity at your event or stalls where they can sell their products or services.

18.4.3 Return on Investment (ROI)

Some events fetch good profits while others barely cover the total cost price. In some cases you may also undergo losses. Therefore, the event managers must know whether the event had any returns on investment. One of the commonly used formulas for calculating ROI is:

$$\text{ROI} = \frac{\text{Total revenue}}{\text{Total investment}}$$

Here are a few tips to increase revenue:

- You can provide merchandising facilities at the venue. You may also want to hold auctions.
- If you have established yourself in the industry then you can also offer franchising opportunities.
- When there is more demand for the tickets, ticket prices can be increased. If your last event was successful then people are waiting for the next event, in such as case, they don't mind paying more than regular prices.

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. Divide the following items as income or expenditure:

- Salaries
- Rent received
- Grants
- Permissions
- Insurance
- Rents payables
- Publicity

2. Expand ROI.

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3. What is the formula for calculating ROI?

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18.5 MARKETING PLANNING FOR EVENTS

The American Marketing Association defines marketing as “the activity, set of institutions, and processes for creating, communicating, delivering, and exchanging offerings that have value for customers, clients, partners, and society at large.”

Like any other product/service marketing, this one too demands application of principles of marketing. Event managers need to first understand the target audience,

understand the profile of target audiences, find out any event that is competing with your theme and dates, understand your audiences' spending power and the price at which they are willing to attend this event, and finally choose your media mix accordingly.

18.5.1 Communication Objectives of Event Marketing

Events are services and not tangible products. While preparing your communication objectives, event managers must understand 5 W's i.e. 'Why, Who, When, Where, and What' and 1 H i.e. How as explained below:

- Why would anybody be interested in attending your event? Why will he/she spend time, energy and resources for the same? Rather than simply inviting them you must give them a reason whether rational or emotional to them to come to the event.
- Who you are planning to invite and who will come to attend it? Event managers may have to call participants, performers, keynote speakers, panel lists and workshop organisers and, on the other hand, they will have to also co-ordinate with potential audiences who would be interested in listening/watching these invitees.
- When are you planning to hold the event? This will give you an idea about how much time you have to reach to your audiences and also choose your media mix.
- The location of the event as well as your audiences should complement each other for the success of the event. This will also help you plan your marketing techniques. Also many people decide to attend based on where the event is taking place.
- What should the people expect from the event? Good packaging, affordable pricing, or may be something completely innovative. 'What' will help marketers position their events.
- And finally 'How' will you go about it? What will be your methods? Are you planning to cook a secret recipe with a magic potion? Sometimes the effectiveness of a message depends more on how it is presented rather than what the message actually is?

18.5.2 Event Management as a Marketing Tool

Event management is one of the forms of BTL i.e. Below the Line marketing strategies. It helps marketers to reach directly to the audiences and they too have realised the potential of this marketing tool. Events have the ability to call potential target group at one place where your message can be communicated to them. The advantages of using events as a marketing tool are:

- You can spend quality time with your target group
- Better face to face interaction
- It is a controlled activity
- It is cheaper than mainstream media
- Very effective in case of niche marketing

- The outcome as compared to the traditional media is measurable and tangible
- Events can be more useful to SME's i.e. small and medium enterprises who do not have huge marketing budgets

18.5.3 Event Marketing Research

The American Marketing Association defines marketing research as, “the function that links the consumer, customer, and public to the marketer through information—information used to identify and define marketing opportunities and problems; generate, refine, and evaluate marketing actions; monitor marketing performance; and improve understanding of marketing as a process. Marketing research specifies the information required to address these issues, designs the method for collecting information, manages and implements the data collection process, analyses the results, and communicates the findings and their implications.”

Research helps event managers to plan and execute more strategically and reduce liability. Market research will help them find out precise solutions, understand current trends and expectations of the audiences and the market, segmenting audiences, understand demand and supply, budget requirements, vendor profiles, assess competition and find out prospective clients.

Some of the resources to gain information about industry trends are government documents, company white papers, newspapers, historical data, event magazines, websites and other sources. Research may be conducted both at pre and post event stages. Broadly there are two main research approaches/methodologies i.e. quantitative and qualitative. Let us understand these in detail:

- **Quantitative:** It focuses on numerical data. When the research is conducted to find out percentages and objective data, quantitative approach is suggested. The conclusions can be generalised to a larger population. Some of the data collection methods are survey and content analysis.
- **Qualitative:** It focuses on subjective data. Looks at patterns and themes rather than percentages. Findings from such research efforts cannot be generalised to a larger population but are close to reality. Some data collection methods are focus group discussion, field observation, and in-depth interviews.

18.5.4 IMC: Elements and their Application for Events

American Association of Advertising Agencies defines IMC i.e. Integrated Marketing Communications as “a comprehensive plan that evaluates the strategic roles of a variety of communication disciplines advertising, public relations, personal selling, and sales promotion and combines them to provide clarity, consistency and maximum communication impact.”



The above figure gives an overview of elements of IMC campaign.

The rules governing market have changed and consumers have more options now. Therefore, any single form of promotion will not work and it has to be an integrated one. Events are direct form of communication; they are not a product but a service. Maintaining and enhancing customer relations is more important as the success of events relies heavily on audience inflow. Both the market and the market forces are very dynamic and the result of this is that consumers will not react in a specific order every time. They may like your event now and dislike it later or vice-versa.

When planning an IMC campaign for the events, one must realize that all IMC campaigns have a golden rule i.e. one message, one look, and one feel. For example, to promote your event a message can be drafted and advertised in different media, a press release may be sent to news channels and newspapers, a press conference may be organized for announcement of the event and brochures/leaflets/pamphlets can be distributed, viral can be made to put it on internet, and social media can be used effectively.

Before deciding on your choice of media, understand the strengths and weaknesses of them and also your budget constraints.

Check Your Progress 4

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. What is marketing?

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2. Expand SME

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3. What is IMC?

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4. Name two commonly used research methodologies.

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18.6 ANALYSING EVENT ENVIRONMENT

18.6.1 PEST Analysis

The business dictionary defines PEST analysis as, “A type of situation analysis in which political-legal, economic, socio-cultural, and technological factors are examined to chart an organization’s long-term plans.” Let us look at each of these factors in detail:

- **Political-legal:** This includes government stability, spending, taxation, employment law, environmental regulations, trade policies, and tariff decisions.
- **Economic:** These include inflation, interest rates, unemployment, exchange rates, and stock markets.
- **Socio-cultural:** Factors included are demographics, education, health and safety, income and age distribution and population growth rate.
- **Technological:** The domain includes research and development activity, inventions, discoveries, patents, licensing, and innovations.

PEST analysis will give detailed understanding of the macro environment of the business. This will lead to better strategic planning, forecast future issues that may arise and take timely action for the same.

18.6.2 SWOT Analysis

It is advisable to conduct SWOT analysis after PEST analysis. Investopedia defines SWOT as “a tool that identifies the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities and threats of an organization. The SWOT analysis is to take the information from an environmental analysis and separate it into internal (strengths and weaknesses) and external issues (opportunities and threats).” Let us look at each of the component in context of event management:

- **Strengths:** These can be the location of your event, innovative product or USP of your event, marketing expertise, a specific performance, design, experienced and skilled human resources, quality processes, high capital, strong goodwill, suppliers, timing of the event or simply any other aspect that will add value to the event.
- **Weaknesses** can be lack of marketing expertise, location of your event, and lack of quality output, damaged reputation, lack of capital, suppliers, lack of goodwill, lack of skilled human resources, timing of the event, or any other aspect of event that will reduce value of it.
- **Opportunities** may be in the form of an emerging marketplace, expansion in new set of audiences, mergers and acquisitions, a market that was previously occupied by your competition, or change in trend.
- **Threats:** Competitors offering better prices, or innovative product and having better channels of distribution, sudden changes in government taxation policies, import-export policy change, or change in trend are some of the possible threats.

SWOT will help in determining not only the objectives but will also the ways of achieving it.

18.6.3 Internal Resource Analysis (IRA)

The event managers must understand their internal resources before they start planning it. IRA will help you understand the budget, man-power, raw materials, venue requirements, software and hardware requirements, and knowledge management.

18.6.4 Competition Analysis

Larry Ellison, co-founder and CEO of Oracle once mentioned, “It’s not enough that we win; all others must lose.” This statement is very apt in today’s cut-throat competition. With globalisation and liberalisation you will hardly find any business sector where businesses enjoy monopoly. Therefore, understanding competition is really vital.

Competitive analysis involves identifying and assessment of your strengths and weaknesses vis-a-vis your competition, understanding your own product and customers, its brand value, and the market place. The possible threat points are:

- Parallel events: Here customers may get divided between two parallel events happening. As event managers you have to ensure that your event dates are not clashing with any other important event.
- Substitutes: available to the customers for entertainment and recreation can also pose a threat. For example, if you are organising a music show, then any other means of entertainment (like a movie) can become a substitute product. If customers start enjoying substitutes more than your product, it will be soon out of market. Ensure that you have a USP i.e. Unique Selling Proposition to enjoy an added advantage.

Check Your Progress 5

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. Match the following:

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|------------------------------------|----------------|
| a. Prime location of your business | a. Threat |
| b. Change in taxation policy | b. Strength |
| c. Mergers and acquisitions | c. Weakness |
| d. Lack of goodwill | d. Opportunity |

2. Explain what is PEST.

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18.7 SUSTAINABLE EVENT MANAGEMENT (SEM)

Like all businesses, event management too has social and environmental obligation. Event manager must understand that profit making should not overpower

environmental degradation. It is suggested that SEM should be taken up at an early stage of the event. Inform about your sustainable objectives to your team and motivate them to follow it or set the rules.

18.7.1 Benefits of SEM

Here are some of the benefits of organizing a green event:

- Consuming optimally will obviously reduce costs and hence more returns on investment.
- If more and more number of events are organised in green manner than the importance of green products will increase.
- You will enjoy more goodwill if your events are green. People will look up to you.
- You will also be influencing others to go green. Be the pioneer and set a benchmark for others to follow.

18.7.2 Practices in SEM

Believe in Reduce-Reuse-Recycle principle when organising events. By using simple steps event managers can save environment. Sustainable practices given here may be followed:

- Choose your venue that is very close to the public transportation. Alternatively, you may also provide pollution free shuttles/vehicles for to and fro of the participants.
- You may choose accommodation at environment friendly hotels. Usually they are listed.
- Choose your suppliers who follow sustainable practices or insist that they follow these.
- Minimise paper use. Print when absolutely necessary. Use internet (email and social media) as much as possible for communicating.
- If at all papers are needed, use recycled papers.
- Use non-toxic stationery. For example, markers, whiteners and others.
- Event proceedings or any other reading resource should be circulated electronically.
- For food, you may use environment friendly plates and glasses that are easily decomposed.
- Minimise food wastage by having an exact headcount. Any leftover should be immediately given to charity.
- Place different bins with instructions wherein participants and visitors should be instructed to throw wastage depending on the type of waste. This will save time and make recycling possible.
- Instead of using paper tissues and napkins, reusable cloth napkins must be used. They can be easily washed and used multiple times.

- Minimise use of cans, cups and bottles by replacing it with large containers. Individual cans and cups cause more pollution and waste.
- Avoid using environment non-friendly items instead use natural materials. For example, vegetables and grass.
- Avoid extra and electricity usage, wherever possible use day lights. Use zero emission equipment.
- Save water as much as you can. Prefer wet cloth cleaning over washing.
- Use compost toilets that do not use water or toxic chemicals.
- Use renewable energy wherever possible.
- Most importantly, monitor the execution of all of the above tips.

Check Your Progress 6

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. Mention five SEM practices.

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2. SEM primarily focuses on _____ principle.

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18.8 POST-EVENT EVALUATION

Evaluation gives an idea of what you expected and what you have achieved. It is advisable to monitor and evaluate your event at different stages of development. For example, at the planning stage, pre-event stage, implementation stage and the post-event stage.

So how does one evaluate the event? Well, you need to take feedback from your participants in the form of surveys or observe them throughout all stages of the event. They are the best judges of your performance. Prepare a checklist and mention all the aspects on which you want them to give you feedback. This collected data can then be interpreted keeping your event goals in mind. You may get answers to questions like did the event meet or exceed budget estimates? How many people were expected and what was the actual number that turned up? What is the general profile (both demographic and psychographic) of the attendees? Which marketing tool succeeded in pulling the maximum audiences?

What was the sponsor's profile? Did the participants like lodging, boarding, food and other facilities? Based on your findings, a research report may be then prepared for future references.

Check Your Progress 7

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. What are the advantages of conducting post-event evaluation?

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18.9 LET US SUM UP

In this unit, we discussed the process of event management. We also looked at role of event manager and his/her key responsibility areas. We discussed the process of event management from conceptualizing it to executing it. We looked at each of the step i.e. logistics, crowd, human resources, risk management in detail. While discussing these, we also had an overview of budgeting in event management.

Event marketing environment was also examined. While doing so, we checked how SWOT analysis, PEST analysis, internal resource analysis and competitive analysis affect event planning. We also briefly discussed sustainable event management and importance of going green.

18.10 KEYWORDS

Event	: Any happening or occurrence.
Live meetings	: Webinars and other types of meetings through the use of virtual mode.
Risk management	: Avoiding possible risks during any event.
Return on investment	: Total revenue divided by total investment.
IMC	: Integrated marketing communication.
PEST analysis	: Politico-legal, economic, socio-cultural and technological analysis.
SEM	: Sustainable event management which is socially and environmentally responsible.

18.11 FURTHER READINGS

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URLS

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18.12 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

1. The word 'event' has its origin from the Latin term 'eventus' which mean occurrence or outcome. Events are a thing that happens or takes place, especially one of importance. These may be planned for official or entertainment purposes.
2. Charity, fund raising, private, sports, government, civic, religious, entertainment and leisure, academic, corporate and business.

Check Your Progress 2

1. People management, transportation, product management, accommodation, infrastructure and communication management, and solid waste management.
2. a) True b) False c) True d) False e) False

Check Your Progress 3

1. a. Income: Salaries, rent received, grants
b. Expenses: Permissions, insurance, rents payables, publicity
2. Return on investments
3. $ROI = \text{Total revenue divided by total investment}$

Check Your Progress 4

1. Marketing is “an activity, set of institutions, and processes for creating, communicating, delivering, and exchanging offerings that have value for customers, clients, partners, and society at large.”
2. Small and medium enterprises
3. Integrated marketing communications
4. Quantitative and qualitative

Check Your Progress 5

1. $1a = b$ $1b = a$ $1c = d$ $1d = c$
2. Political-legal, economical, socio-cultural, technological

Check Your Progress 6

1. Use renewable energy wherever possible, avoid extra and electricity usage, minimise food wastage by having an exact headcount, minimise use of chemicals and toxins and do not print or use paper unnecessarily.
2. Reduce-reuse-recycle principle

Check Your Progress 7

1. Event managers will get better understanding of budget estimates, audience profiles, and the success of marketing tool in reaching to its audiences. It will also tell you whether your event was liked or disliked by the audiences and the sponsors.